determination to make a car like the Nano. Toyota also joined the race. In January 2010, at the Delhi Auto Expo, it exhibited its ‘Etios concept, which the company said was developed by studying the Indian market’.

Companies outside the automobile segment were also inspired. *The Economist* remarked on how ‘General Electric and Tata’s chemicals arm have applied frugal engineering techniques to produce cheap products with great success. GE, for instance, has developed basic medical scanners in India and now sells them in the West.’

Tata Motors too has taken advantage of the spinoffs from the Nano experience. It developed several layers of capabilities in the organization, comments Wagh. Low-cost engineering became a byword in the company. Several of the innovations were profitably employed in third-generation cars like the Tiago and Tigor. The Nano project also gave Tata Motors the opportunity to produce petrol engines, something it had never done before. A Tata-produced gasoline engine now powers the Tiago and the Punch (the latter has become the largest-selling car in India for the period January to July 2024). The project ‘developed world-class quality at Indian costs’, and consequently, now the Tata cars have thinner skins on them, Wagh points out.

Besides, Wagh says, the Nano project changed the company’s work culture. It spawned important ‘softer competencies’, such as a ‘never say die attitude’, the drive and ‘capability to innovate’, ‘resilience and perseverance’.

Internationally, the Nano’s design received almost universal praise, capturing the imagination of the world. The Cooper-Hewitt National Design Museum at the Smithsonian selected the car for display in its Great Hall, a rare honour. It exhibited the Nano because it was the ‘world’s most affordable car, it is a design achievement’, Cara McCarty, the museum’s curatorial director, told *The New York Times*. The design was considered so interesting that the car poster was hung on the museum fence with the caption, ‘actual size’.

It also had ‘considerable influence on car designers, and it has already changed the automobile industry’, Geoff Wardle, the director for Advanced Mobility Research at the Art Center College of Design in Pasadena, California, told *The New York Times*. ‘My particular fascination about the Nano is what I refer to as the “Nano effect” on the rest of the world’s vehicle industry.’ Commenting on its impact, he said, ‘People all over the